

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from a website:

Is there truth in advertising?

The average consumer is overwhelmed with somewhere between 500 and 1300 advertising messages per day. When we get up in the morning and turn on the television or the radio, there will be anywhere from 15 to 25 commercials. As we travel to school or work, we will be exposed to billboards, signage, business logos, advertisements on other vehicles, etc. which will add another 10 to 20 ads.

Unfortunately, a lot of the messages that we are being exposed to may be less than honest. A good example of this comes in the form of weight loss supplements. They proclaim, "Take these pills and you will lose weight 30 percent faster without diet or exercise." Others say, "These pills work uniquely with a woman's body to increase the amount of weight loss." Unfortunately about 95 percent of all of the diet programs are not as effective as advertised.

The success of a product does not rely only on its advertising but also on its quality. Many advertising campaigns fail because the product doesn't deliver on the promises made in the advertisements. Companies are well advised not to exaggerate or over-promise, since advertising can only make people buy the product the first time. Once customers discover the product is not good, they will not buy it again.

Your group has to prepare for a debate with the motion "Advertising does more good than harm to society". Discuss with your group what to include in this debate. You may want to talk about:

- positive effects of advertising on society
- negative effects of advertising on society
- what products should not be advertised
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. What kinds of advertisements do you like?
2. Do you think there are too many advertisements on TV?
3. Do you find advertisements entertaining?
4. Do you think it is effective to advertise products on buses and the MTR?
5. Are there any negative effects that advertising may have on young children?
6. Would you like to live in an advertisement-free society?
7. Which attracts more customers – a quality product or a good advertisement?
8. What makes a TV advertisement effective?